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Operation InVersion at LinkedIn

The case study Operation InVersion at LinkedIn describes how the company addressed serious problems with software delivery in 2011. During this period, LinkedIn released software every few weeks using large code changes. These releases caused frequent outages, slow recovery, and high stress for engineering teams. Tightly connected systems increased deployment risk and made failures harder to manage.

To address these issues, LinkedIn launched Operation InVersion. The initiative focused on reversing the traditional release process. Engineers began deploying code to production more frequently while keeping new features disabled. Teams adopted feature flags and trunk based development to support smaller changes. This shift reduced deployment risk and improved system stability. LinkedIn also invested in automated testing, monitoring, and closer collaboration between development and operations teams.

Several lessons emerge from the case study. You benefit from deploying small changes frequently because failures affect fewer components and recovery happens faster. Feature flags separate deployment from release, which improves control and safety. Shared ownership between development and operations strengthens trust and speeds up incident response. Automation and system visibility support fast feedback and better decision making. The case study shows DevOps success depends on organizational culture rather than tools alone.

Works Cited

Kim, Gene, Jez Humble, Patrick Debois, and John Willis. The DevOps Handbook. 2nd ed., IT Revolution Press, 2021.